

# SENATE CHAMBER

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

DISPOSITION



FLOOR AMENDMENT

No. \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_



COMMITTEE AMENDMENT

\_\_\_\_\_

(Date)

I move to amend Senate Bill No. 1413, page 1, line 15 1/2, by inserting new Sections 1 and 2 as follows, by renumbering subsequent sections, and by amending the title to conform.

Submitted by:

\_\_\_\_\_  
Senator Deevers

Deevers-EB-FA-SB1413

3/17/2026 4:09 PM

1       SECTION 1.       NEW LAW       A new section of law not to be  
2       codified in the Oklahoma Statutes reads as follows:  
3       The Legislature finds that:  
4       1. Timely teacher licensure is essential to ensuring that  
5       public school districts are able to staff classrooms effectively  
6       and provide uninterrupted instruction to students;  
7       2. Administrative delay in the teacher licensure process can  
8       contribute to teacher shortages, particularly in rural and high-

(Floor Amendments Only)   Date and Time Filed: \_\_\_\_\_



Untimely



Amendment Cycle Extended



Secondary Amendment

1 need school districts, and undermine local efforts to recruit  
2 qualified educators;

3 3. School district boards of education are often best  
4 positioned to evaluate the qualifications, character, and readiness  
5 of teacher candidates to meet the instructional needs of their  
6 communities;

7 4. Excessive centralization of teacher licensure decisions can  
8 create unnecessary barriers to employment and delay the placement  
9 of otherwise qualified teachers in classrooms in this state; and

10 5. Clear timelines and accountability in the teacher licensure  
11 process promote efficiency, transparency, and responsiveness while  
12 preserving statutory standards and state-level oversight.

13 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified  
14 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 5-117.8 of Title 70, unless  
15 there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

16 A. This act shall be known and may be cited as the "Local  
17 Teacher Licensure Act". The purpose of the Local Teacher Licensure  
18 Act shall be to grant school district boards of education the  
19 authority to evaluate and recommend teacher licensure or  
20 certification applications. The State Board of Education shall  
21 maintain final oversight and ratification authority over the  
22 issuance of teacher licenses or certificates in compliance with  
23 Section 5 of Article XIII of the Oklahoma Constitution and Section  
24 3-104 of Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes.

(Floor Amendments Only) Date and Time Filed: \_\_\_\_\_

☐ Untimely ☐ Amendment Cycle Extended ☐ Secondary Amendment

1 B. School district boards of education are hereby authorized  
2 to evaluate and recommend approval of teacher licensure or  
3 certification applications to the State Board of Education based on  
4 the standards set forth in Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes.

5 C. Upon receiving a recommendation for licensure or  
6 certification from a school district board of education, the State  
7 Board of Education shall:

8 1. Review the recommendation for completeness and compliance  
9 with statutory requirements including, but not limited to, Sections  
10 5-142, 6-107, 6-122.3, 6-187, and 6-190 of Title 70 of the Oklahoma  
11 Statutes. A recommendation shall be considered complete when the  
12 Board has received all documentation showing compliance with the  
13 statutory provisions in place for teacher licensure or  
14 certification when the recommendation was submitted;

15 2. Approve or reject the licensure or certification  
16 recommendations within thirty (30) calendar days of receipt; and

17 3. Provide written notification of approval or rejection to  
18 the recommending school district board of education and the  
19 licensure or certification applicant.

20 D. Failure of the State Board of Education to act on a  
21 recommendation within thirty (30) calendar days pursuant to  
22 subsection C of this section shall result in the Board's automatic  
23 approval of the license or certificate; provided, however, that the  
24 recommendation submitted by the school district board of education

(Floor Amendments Only) Date and Time Filed: \_\_\_\_\_

☐ Untimely ☐ Amendment Cycle Extended ☐ Secondary Amendment

1 meets all statutory and procedural requirements for teacher  
2 licensure or certification set forth in Title 70 of the Oklahoma  
3 Statutes and the rules promulgated by the Board.

4 E. Teacher licenses or certificates issued pursuant to the  
5 provisions of this section shall be valid for a term of five (5)  
6 years from the date of issuance and shall be subject to renewal in  
7 accordance with the provisions of Section 6-108.1 of Title 70 of  
8 the Oklahoma Statutes.

9 F. The State Board of Education shall retain oversight of all  
10 teacher licensure or certification processes, and the State  
11 Department of Education shall maintain all records regarding  
12 teacher licenses or certificates issued pursuant to this section.

13 G. School district boards of education shall establish  
14 transparent procedures for licensure or certification  
15 recommendations including:

16 1. Timelines for application submission, which shall provide  
17 teacher license or certificate applicants with a minimum of twenty  
18 (20) calendar days to complete the process;

19 2. A timeline for board of education review and approval or  
20 rejection, not to exceed thirty (30) calendar days from the date of  
21 application submission; and

22 3. Written notification to the teacher license or certificate  
23 applicant and the State Department of Education within five (5)  
24 business days of the board of education's decision.

(Floor Amendments Only) Date and Time Filed: \_\_\_\_\_

☐ Untimely

☐ Amendment Cycle Extended

☐ Secondary Amendment

1       H. Neither a school district nor its board of education shall  
2 be liable for civil damages arising solely from a recommendation  
3 submitted pursuant to the provisions of this section.

4       I. The State Board of Education may promulgate rules strictly  
5 necessary to implement the provisions of this section.

(Floor Amendments Only)   Date and Time Filed: \_\_\_\_\_

☐ Untimely                      ☐ Amendment Cycle Extended   ☐ Secondary Amendment